

HOW TO REQUEST TIME OFF (EMPLOYEE GUIDE)

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Audience: Employees

System path: People Portal / company HR system -Time Off

Policy source: 02_leave_and_time_off_policy.md

Goal

Submit annual leave, sick leave, or other absence so your manager can approve it and your balance updates correctly.

Before you start

1. Check the Leave and Time Off Policy for notice periods and documents.
2. Confirm you are not in a published blackout period (or accept manager may decline).
3. For sick leave ≥ 2 consecutive days, prepare a medical certificate scan/photo.
4. Do not share full medical details in the comment field - "medical cert attached" is enough.

Steps - desktop (Time Off)

1. Sign in to the People Portal (company HR system).
2. Open the home page and select Time Off (or search "Time Off" in global search).
3. Choose Request Time Off (or New Absence).
4. Select Time Type (e.g. Annual Leave, Sick Leave).
5. Enter start date and end date.
 - For half-day: enable half-day and choose AM or PM if available.
6. Review the deduction preview / balance impact shown by the system.
7. Add an optional comment for your manager (reason at high level only).
8. Attach medical certificate or other required file if applicable.
9. Click Submit.
10. Status becomes Pending until your manager acts.

Steps - mobile (HR mobile app)

1. Open the company HR mobile app and sign in.
2. Tap Time Off / Absences.
3. Tap + or Request.
4. Select type, dates, half-day if needed.
5. Attach file if required -Submit.

After submit

Status | Meaning | What you do

Pending | Waiting on manager | Wait; optional polite reminder after SLA

Approved | Counted against balance | Take leave as planned

Declined | Not approved | Read comment; resubmit or discuss offline
Cancelled | You or admin cancelled | Rebook if still needed

Cancel or edit

1. Open Time Off -My Requests.
2. Select the request.
3. Withdraw/Cancel if still pending or if policy allows cancel after approval (manager may need to re-approve changes).
4. To change dates, cancel and create a new request unless edit is enabled for your tenant.

Manager SLA (internal target)

Managers should action routine leave within 2 working days. Escalation: ping manager once, then HRBP if blocked before travel.

Common errors

Symptom | Likely cause | Fix

Cannot submit | Missing mandatory field / attachment | Complete required fields

Wrong balance | Pending older request | Check pending items first

Type greyed out | Not eligible / not hired fully | Contact HR

Overlap error | Existing absence same days | Edit/cancel prior request

Related questions employees ask

- "How many AL days do I get?" -see Leave policy entitlement table.
- "Can I carry leave?" -up to 5 days, use by 31 March.
- "Do I need a doctor note?" -yes for 2+ consecutive sick days.

Guardrails for AI answers

- Walk through these steps.
- Cite this how-to + leave policy.
- Never claim a specific person's remaining balance.
- Never submit the request on the employee's behalf.